Although Warren Buffett officially named Greg Abel as his successor in May 2025, an earlier 2011 article identified Ted Weschler as a potential candidate. The citation remains relevant in illustrating how Weschler's meticulous approach to analyzing firms helped shape his successful career. Since joining Berkshire in 2012, he—alongside Todd Combs—has played a key role in managing significant portions of the company's equity portfolio

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A Disciplined and Driven 'Connect-the-Dots' Investor

By STEVE EDER And JASON ZWEIG

CHARLOTTESVILLE, Va.—Two days ago, Richard "Ted" Weschler was a successful but unsung hedge-fund manager in this city of 43,000 people hundreds of miles from Wall Street.

Now, a day after the world learned that Mr. Weschler will be working as one of two investment managers under stock picker extraordinaire Warren Buffett, the 50-year-old investor is a minor financial celebrity.

It is a turn in the limelight that Mr. Weschler hasn't been craving, but he can't easily avoid it now that Mr. Buffett is due to hand him as much as $3 billion in investing authority when Mr. Weschler joins Omaha, Neb.-based Berkshire Hathaway Inc. next year.

Matt Eich / LUCEO for The Wall Street Journal

Warren Buffett's new recruit, Richard 'Ted' Weschler, stands in front of his Charlottesville, Va., office Tuesday.

"I really try to stay low profile," Mr. Weschler told The Wall Street Journal on Tuesday outside his office on a quaint block of downtown Charlottesville filled with art stores and restaurants. He admitted that trying to keep that status while working for Mr. Buffett might be a bit of an "oxymoron."

Mr. Weschler stepped out around noon to get a salad at the Blue Ridge Country Store, about a block from his office. As soon as he stepped outside, he was greeted by friends and neighbors congratulating him on his new job.

Mr. Weschler politely thanked the well-wishers, exchanged some handshakes, declined an extensive interview and said he was planning to meet with investors in his Peninsula Capital Advisors LLC later Tuesday. The fund holds roughly $2 billion in assets.

Mr. Weschler was wearing a white button-down shirt with his initials embroidered on the pocket, along with a red-and-blue tie. He smiled and laughed as he made small talk, and said he was "astounded" that a reporter would come down from New York in hopes of speaking with him.

Yet Mr. Weschler's record running Peninsula makes it clear why Mr. Buffett and, now, many of Mr. Weschler's neighbors, are eager to make his acquaintance.

Peninsula turned in a strong double-digit-percentage annualized return over the past decade, while the broad Standard & Poor's 500-stock index was basically flat.

Who exactly is Ted Weschler, Warren Buffett's newest recruit? And how has he achieved the stellar investment returns that endeared him to the Sage of Omaha? Jason Zweig has details on The News Hub

A major driver of Peninsula's gains was a prescient investment in chemical company W.R. Grace & Co., where he worked years earlier and which filed for Chapter 11 bankruptcy protection in 2001 after facing claims for damages associated with asbestos.

Since then, Grace's shares have climbed from about $2 a share to over $50 in July. Shares in the company, which still is in bankruptcy protection, rose $2.05, or 6%, to $36.34, in 4 p.m. New York Stock Exchange composite trading Tuesday. Based on shareholdings as of June 30, Peninsula's position in Grace is valued at $391 million.

Yet one investor in Peninsula estimates that, if Mr. Weschler had never invested in W.R. Grace, the fund still would have gone up sevenfold or eightfold since its inception in 2000.

Peninsula's success in buying and holding investments such as W.R. Grace and dialysis company DaVita Inc. stem from Mr. Weschler's investing discipline, say acquaintances and investing partners. Just as Mr. Buffett has long done, Mr. Weschler zeroes in on roughly a dozen companies, draws on information from an extensive network of business contacts, works in a small office, shuns conventional investment thinking and holds stocks for years at a time.

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Also like Mr. Buffett, Mr. Weschler has experience not only with buying stocks in the public market but with acquiring entire companies outright in the private market. In a recent letter to his investors, Mr. Weschler reported that he has explicitly sought to model his investing style on Mr. Buffett's.

Several people who know Mr. Weschler describe him as having a lot in common to what they know of Mr. Buffett.

If there's a secret to Mr. Weschler's success, he said it is that he reads. A lot. A person who has been in his office noted that he has stacks of 10-K filings, or company annual reports, all over his office, and he reads them himself. He shares the office with an associate and an assistant.

"Ted will spend months quietly in the corner trying to understand a particular issue, then he emerges like a quiet reporter of what he's learned," says Patrick Grace, a private investor in New York and son of Peter Grace, the late chief executive of W.R. Grace, the conglomerate where Mr. Weschler first learned how to analyze potential acquisitions. "Ted could be living in Tahiti doing what he's doing, he's so mentally disciplined."

Mr. Weschler said he looks at investing as a game of "connect the dots," taking various pieces of information to get the whole picture of a company.

"I can see why Warren Buffett would warm to him," says Edwin Burton, a professor of finance at the University of Virginia who says he has known Mr. Weschler for 15 years. "He's self-effacing, he takes his time, he's one of the most disciplined people you'll ever meet, and he sees the world differently from others."

The origins of Mr. Weschler's career trace to W.R. Grace, where in the 1980s he worked as an assistant to Peter Grace. Mr. Weschler later joined Quad-C Management Inc., a private-equity firm in Charlottesville. Executives at Quad-C didn't return a message seeking comment.

At Peninsula, Mr. Weschler has sought to build a portfolio of companies in which he sees deep value. As an investor in W.R. Grace, he has played a hands-on role in its bankruptcy proceedings, sitting at the negotiating table with CEO Fred Festa and also serving as the head of the equity committee, a role he will keep, Mr. Festa said.

"At the end of the day, Ted wants to understand what makes a company tick," Mr. Festa said. "When he finds that, that's where he'll invest."

A couple of weeks ago, after an earthquake shook Virginia, the people working in Mr. Weschler's building cleared out onto Main Street, including the workers in the New Dominion Bookshop downstairs. Eleanor Franzen, the

manager of the bookstore, said she was shaken by the earthquake, but found Mr. Weschler and his office manager to be comforting.

People who know Mr. Weschler say he goes running every single day without fail, come rain, sleet, snow or high heat. He often is seen "huffing around town, at all hours, sweaty," one person says.

Mr. Weschler once ran every day for 25 straight years, dating back to college. But one day he broke the streak to show he didn't have to do it each day, the people said.

"That typifies his work pattern and his demeanor," Mr. Festa said. "Ted is a very driven individual."

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Warren Buffett

Warren Buffett announces retirement from leading Berkshire Hathaway

Billionaire shocked audience of investors with disclosure and said his vice-chair, Greg Abel, should take over

Warren Buffett in 2019. Photograph: Nati Harnik/AP

Nina Lakhani *and agencies*

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Warren Buffett, the billionaire investor and philanthropist, has announced his intention to retire at the end of this year. He is 94 years old.

Buffett, the fifth-richest person in the world, shocked an arena full of shareholders on Saturday when he announced that he would step down as the CEO and chair of the trillion-dollar conglomerate Berkshire Hathaway at the end of 2025. He will recommend to the 11-person board that his vice-

chair, Greg Abel, who currently oversees most of the company's investments, be named as his successor, Buffett said.

The thousands of investors at the arena in Omaha, Nebraska, gave Buffett a lengthy standing ovation in recognition of his 60 years of leading the company.

"I think the time has arrived where Greg should become the chief executive officer of the company at year end," Buffett said.

"I have no intention - zero - of selling one share of Berkshire Hathaway. I will give it away eventually," Buffett said. "The decision to keep every share is an economic decision because I think the prospects of Berkshire will be better under Greg's management than mine."

Buffett made the announcement at the end of a five-hour question-and-answer session, and did not take any queries about his retirement plans. The only board members who knew about the announcement in advance were his children, Howard and Susie Buffett, he said. Abel, who was sitting next to Buffett on stage, was unaware, but stood to join the crowd in applauding his boss.

Abel, 62, who was born in Alberta, Canada, has been Buffett's designated successor as CEO since 2001. He is a 25-year Berkshire veteran and already manages all of the conglomerate's non-insurance businesses including dozens of fossil energy, chemical, real estate and retail operations. But despite Buffett's advanced age, the announcement came as a shock as the Berkshire CEO previously insisted that he had no plans to retire.

Buffett has led the Omaha-based company since 1965, and is credited by many with transforming Berkshire from a flailing textiles manufacturer into a $1.03tn conglomerate with dozens of businesses in insurance, railroad, energy and other sectors.

Buffett, a Democrat, has previously said that he plans to donate 99.5% of his remaining wealth to a charitable trust overseen by his daughter and two sons when he dies. According to Forbes, Buffett has a net worth of $165.3bn.

Earlier on Saturday, Buffett warned about the dire global consequences of Donald Trump's tariffs, telling thousands of investors gathered at the annual meeting that "there's no question that trade can be an act of war".

Buffett said Trump's trade policies have raised the risk of global instability by angering the rest of the world.

"It's a big mistake in my view when you have 7.5 billion people who don't like you very well, and you have 300 million who are crowing about how they have done.

"We should be looking to trade with the rest of the world. We should do what we do best and they should do what they do best," he said.

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In February, Berkshire reported a third straight record annual operating profit, rising 27%, to $47.44bn, in 2024. It's unclear what impact Trump's tariffs will have on Berkshire's 189 operating businesses and shareholder profits.

Buffett, a longtime Democratic mover and shaker, did not endorse Kamala Harris in 2024 or Joe Biden in 2020. He had previously endorsed Barack Obama twice and Hillary Clinton.

Buffett has faced his share of controversies including anti-trust investigations and criticism from fire victims after Berkshire's PacifiCorp utility failed to shut off power lines during a Labor Day weekend windstorm in 2020, leading to deadly wildfires spreading in Oregon and northern California.

Speaking before the retirement bombshell, Abel said that "keeping the lights on" is no longer a priority for the conglomerate's utilities when the threat of wildfires becomes excessive.

"It's around protecting the general public and being sure the fire doesn't spread further," he said.

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